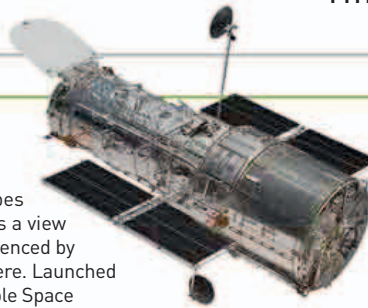


Lunar rover

1971
First Lunar Roving Vehicle
American astronauts on the Apollo 15, 16, and 17 missions explore the Moon with an electric car called the Lunar Roving Vehicle.

1973
Missions to Mars
In 1973, Soviet probe Mars 2 reaches Mars—one part of it sent back pictures from orbit, the other crashed while attempting to land. In 1975, the American Viking 1 successfully landed and sent back data for six years.

1990
Space telescope
Orbiting telescopes give astronomers a view of space not influenced by Earth's atmosphere. Launched in 1990, the Hubble Space Telescope (HST) is the most well-known space telescope.



Hubble Space Telescope

1998
ISS
The International Space Station is a collaboration between 16 countries. It is launched in 1998 and assembled bit by bit over 14 years.

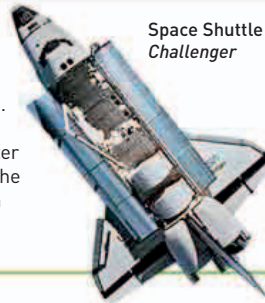


ISS

1969
Man on the Moon
On July 21, Neil Armstrong becomes the first human to set foot on the Moon. As he steps on to the Moon's surface, he says, "One small step for [a] man, one giant leap for mankind."

1971
First space station
On April 19, the first space station, the Salyut 1, is launched by the Soviet Union. Later in the year, the first crew of three stays on board for 23 days.

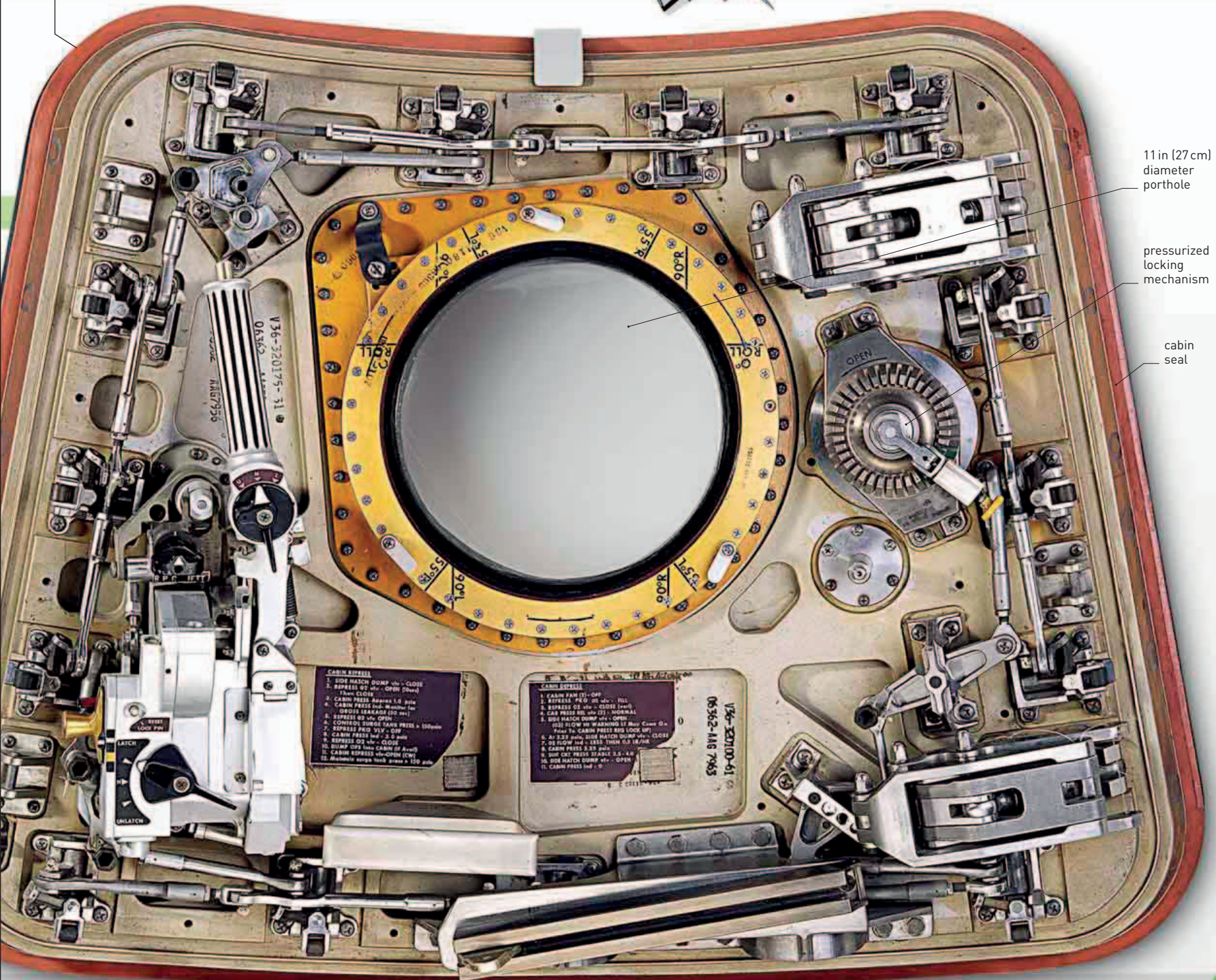
1981
Space Shuttle
The first spacecraft were designed to be used only once. The Space Shuttle is the first reusable craft, able to land after a mission like an aeroplane. The USSR built the similar, though much less successful, Buran.



Space Shuttle Challenger

1995
Galileo
NASA's Galileo probe becomes the first spacecraft to orbit the Solar System's largest planet, Jupiter. It beams back many images of Jupiter's moons and also the impact of comet Shoemaker Levy 9.

2012
Mars Curiosity
NASA's Curiosity Rover, a car-sized robot exploration vehicle, lands in Gale Crater on Mars on August 6. The latest in a series of similar missions, it studies rocks and climate, and searches for signs of water and microbial life.



11 in (27 cm) diameter porthole

pressurized locking mechanism

cabin seal